

Game Jam Proposal: Twist & Turn

Themes: Comic, Twist, Light

Target Playtime: 10–15 Minutes

Team: Lexicons

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1. Game Overview

"**Twist & Turn**" is a genre-bending action-adventure game that alternates between a 2D puzzle-exploration maze and a 3D hack-and-slash brawler. The game contrasts two distinct dimensions: a dark, fun, and witty 2D comic world and a brightly lit, colorful, but utterly joyless 3D world. The player must navigate the dark maze, transition through dimensions, and battle the oppressive "Fun Police" to bring illumination and joy back to both realms.

2. The Two Worlds (Setting & Aesthetics)

- **The 2D Comic World:** A flat, monochromatic, comic-book environment. It is filled with humor, charm, and witty NPC characters. However, it is shrouded in darkness. Many paths and secrets are completely invisible without the introduction of a light source.
- **The 3D Light World:** A fully 3D, vibrant, and brightly illuminated battleground. Despite the beautiful colors and lighting, it is a sterile, boring place ruled by the "Fun Police"—authoritarian rogue agents who despise passion and want to keep the dimensions separated.

3. Core Gameplay Loop

The 10-15 minute deliverable will focus on a tight, repeating cycle of exploration, dimension-hopping, and combat across 2-3 short levels, culminating in the final narrative encounter.

1. **Explore (2D):** The Main Character (MC) explores the 2D maze, interacting with quirky comic NPC mascots who provide humorous clues. The MC hits dead-ends shrouded in darkness.
2. **The Twist (Portal):** To progress, the MC finds a literal "Twist" portal. Entering it twists the very fabric of the game space, shifting the perspective from a 2D maze into a 3D arena.
3. **Combat (3D):** In the 3D battleground, the MC faces off against the Fun Police. By dodging and attacking, the player earns "Light Points."
4. **Return & Progress (2D):** Victorious, the MC returns through the Twist portal to the 2D world. The collected Light Points are spent to reveal the hidden dark paths in the maze, allowing the player to discover an upgraded weapon and advance to the next level.

4. Key Mechanics

The Weapon Health System (No Player HP)

- Unlike traditional games, the MC does not have a health bar. Instead, **the equipped weapon possesses both the Damage and HP stats.**
- Taking damage reduces the weapon's HP. If the weapon breaks (HP drops to zero) during a 3D arena fight, the MC is sent back to a resurrection point to restart the 3D level.
- This creates a compelling progression system: every time the player unlocks a new section of the 2D maze, they are rewarded with a newly forged, higher-tier weapon, preparing them for the escalating difficulty of the next 3D battleground.

Light Points Economy

- Light Points act as both a combat reward and an exploration key. Points collected in a 3D level are strictly ephemeral—they only last for the current tier of the 2D maze. This forces the player to engage with the "Twist" mechanic and re-enter the 3D world to progress further.

5. Components & Assets Plan

To ensure scoping fits the 100-hour jam, we are focusing on the following core assets: **2D Components:**

- A multi-layered maze tilemap with toggleable "dark paths" (revealed via Light Points).
- Dialogue systems for witty, static comic NPCs who serve as guides.
- Interactable weapon pickup sprites featuring escalating stats.
- 2D "Twist" Portal entrance/exit animations.

3D Components:

- A contained, vibrantly lit 3D arena battleground.
- Basic "Fun Police" character animations(chase, basic attack, damage reception).
- "Light Points" being dropped by defeated enemies.
- 3D "Twist" Portal entrance/exit animations.

6. Narrative Climax (The Final Deliverable)

The 15-minute loop ends in a cinematic narrative resolution: After clearing the final wave of Fun Police in the 3D world, the MC finally encounters the physical embodiment of **"Light"** (Male). The MC explains the plight of the separated worlds. Light lends his illuminating power to the MC, who takes it back through the Twist portal to the 2D world. There, the light reveals the final hidden entity: **"Fun"** (Female), who has been trapped in the dark. The game concludes as Light and Fun unite, merging the aesthetic of the two dimensions into one vibrant, joyful comic world.

7. Theme Integration Summary

- **Comic:** Represented through the 2D world's distinct art style, the quirky dialogue of the NPCs, and the literal personification of "Fun."
- **Twist:** Mechanically and visually represented by the "Twist Portal," which acts as a literal twist in space, shifting the game genre from 2D exploration to 3D combat.
- **Light:** The central driving force of the game. It is a visual necessity to reveal the 2D map, a collectable currency in the 3D world, and the ultimate narrative goal.